MIA XR COLLECTIVE PITCH · ROME · 22 OCTOBER 2026

# Engine Mastery × Craft

Why the studios winning in immersive need both

**Alex Coulombe**
CEO, Agile Lens: Immersive Design



YOUR SPEAKER

# Alex Coulombe

**Founder & CEO, Agile Lens: Immersive Design**

Architect turned XR-chitect who has spent the last decade building spatial experiences for the world's most ambitious clients.

Authorized Unreal Engine instructor since 2020: 300+ classes taught, 40+ courses written.

| 16 | 10 | 10 | 100+ |
|---|---|---|---|
| YEARS IN XR | YEARS OF AGILE LENS | YEARS IN UNREAL | EXPERIENCES BUILT |

ROYAL SHAKESPEARE COMPANY

CBS

FOUR SEASONS

ARLEKIN PLAYERS

WALDORF ASTORIA

# AGILE LENS

IMMERSIVE DESIGN STUDIO

EST. 2016

NYC

LINCOLN CENTER

KENNEDY CENTER

FISHER DACHS ASSOCIATES

ACTORS THEATRE OF LOUISVILLE

SAMSUNG

DELL

ROYAL CARIBBEAN

BOOTSTRAPPED · XR SPECIALISTS · 10 YEARS

ACT I · 1 / 4

# Beautiful Demos Are Easy. Shipping Them Isn't.

Immersive work lives or dies in the gap between the trailer and the headset

Engine mastery: it runs, beautifully, on the hardware audiences actually have

Craft: once they're inside, they care

ENGINE MASTERY · CRAFT

We teach the engine we build in

# 300+ classes taught.
# 40+ courses written.

*Authorized Unreal Engine instructor since 2020*



*A Christmas Carol VR* 2025 trailer · Agile Lens

ACT I · TWO HALVES

# Photoreal That Actually Runs

Heavy scenes, real hardware

- We optimized photoreal digital humans to run on standalone headsets
- That moved *A Christmas Carol VR* from gaming PCs to headsets audiences already own
- Increasing access is worth the work, as long as the artistic vision survives

Royal Caribbean · Perfect Day Mexico

# Nearly 1,000 guests. Four days at sea.

*A hot-air-balloon ride over Perfect Day Mexico, aboard Utopia of the Seas, September 2025 · Standalone headsets, offline, about 10 minutes a ride, run by the client's volunteers from our operations manual*

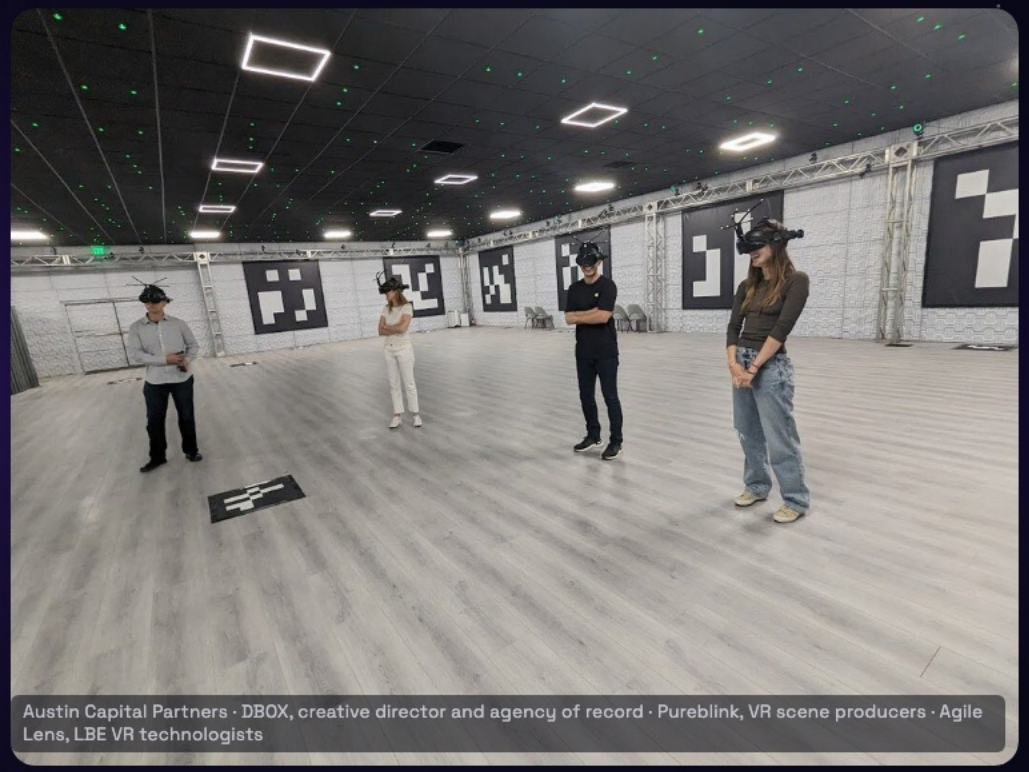
PICO Space Pro

# First company in the US with access to PICO Space Pro.

ACT II · 2 / 4

# Fidelity That Converts.

Luxury brands don't buy demos. They buy belief.



Austin Capital Partners · DBOX, creative director and agency of record · Pureblink, VR scene producers · Agile Lens, LBE VR technologists

ACT II · FIDELITY

# Four Seasons Private Residences

Lake Austin: luxury homes, toured from a headset

- Buyers walk full-scale, photoreal residences years before they're built
- A wireless, walkable holodeck of about 5,000 square feet: families tour together, no cables
- We engineered the location-based VR, set it up, and ran its first six months of operation

# The Part Nobody Sees



Holodeck build for Four Seasons Private Residences, Lake Austin · Agile Lens, LBE VR technologists


Four Seasons tours at DBOX, New York
Headset on in New York.
Standing in Austin.

eVTOL air-taxi passenger simulation

# Take the flight before it exists.

*A passenger-flight simulation for an eVTOL air-taxi company: a ride over New York*

ACT III · 3 / 4

# Craft Is the Other Half.

Engine mastery gets the scene running. Craft decides whether anyone cares.



ACT III · CRAFT

# A Christmas Carol VR

Live actors. Live audiences. One shared virtual stage.

- Live actors with face and full-body capture perform on the streets of a virtual Victorian London
- Fully remote: actors, crew and audience each join from wherever they are
- Five holiday seasons, 2021–2025 · The final run, December 2025: 15 performances




*A Christmas Carol VR* · Agile Lens · performed live by Ari Tarr and Debbie Deer · adapted by Robert Barry Fleming

# In Their Words

Raindance Immersive 2025 nominee, Best Immersive Theatre · Audience comments as published on xmascarolvr.com, 2021–2025

"WOW doesn't even come close to describing what I just experienced! I haven't enjoyed 'A Christmas Carol' this much in years."

**Robert Copelan, audience**
xmascarolvr.com · 2024

"Each year, Agile Lens is like pushing the edge for what's next."

**Kent Bye**
Voices of VR podcast · 2025

"A Christmas Carol VR is a masterclass in acting"

**Raindance Immersive 2025 judges**
as quoted on xmascarolvr.com · 2025

"We're extremely curious to see what Agile Lens and their creators do next with theatre in VR"

**Ian Hamilton**
UploadVR, editorial · 2025

"I sat on that bench and looked up at Scrooge... and [he] emotionally spoke, of me... It felt remarkable!"

**Chuck Webster, MD, audience**
xmascarolvr.com · 2024

"This was a working glimpse into the future of VR as a medium for Real Time Live Production."

**Jimmy6DOF, audience**
xmascarolvr.com · 2021

"It was fascinating to see the affordances of VR used in this way. I'd love to see more VR plays done like this."

**Claren Naïlo, audience**
xmascarolvr.com · 2024

"Agile Lens represents a model of artistry that transcends mediums and time zones alike."

**Siobhan Greene, Instinctively Real Media**
the show's media sponsor · 2025

"The evolution of this show over the years is remarkable and the performances are top shelf!"

**Stephen Butchko, audience**
xmascarolvr.com · 2025

"Quite enjoyed catching the opening night of this. The world needs more live VR performances!"

**Nick Suda, audience**
xmascarolvr.com · 2025



XR Network+ RSC Challenge 2025 film · Agile Lens

ACT III · CRAFT

# Royal Shakespeare Company

Virtual rehearsal tools, developed with the RSC

- Actors rehearse in a 1:1 scan of the Swan Theatre; directors follow along from a laptop
- Built with theater people, for theater people: the script stays in your hand, like paper
- An R&D grant with XR Network+, 2024–2025: tested with drama students, shown in Stratford

# Same Rehearsal, Two Rooms

Drag the line



# XR Inside a Normal Film Pipeline

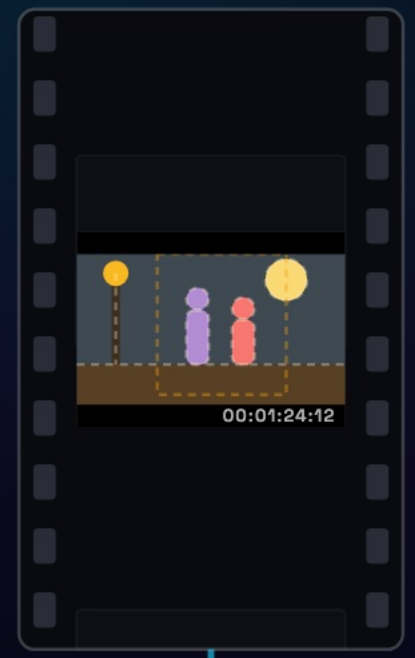
The crew uses the headset. The audience gets a normal film.



XR for the crew

| PRE-PRODUCTION | PRODUCTION | POST-PRODUCTION |
| --- | --- | --- |
| ● Scout a scanned location in VR | ● Rehearse actors in the virtual set | ● Shoot new coverage from recordings |
| ● Try lenses, lights and blocking at 1:1 | ● Capture performance onto digital humans | ● Reframe with a virtual camera |
| ● Pull stills into the shot list | ○ Real-time previs and virtual sets | ● Review in VR, like dailies |

● Agile Lens has built this ○ What XR can do

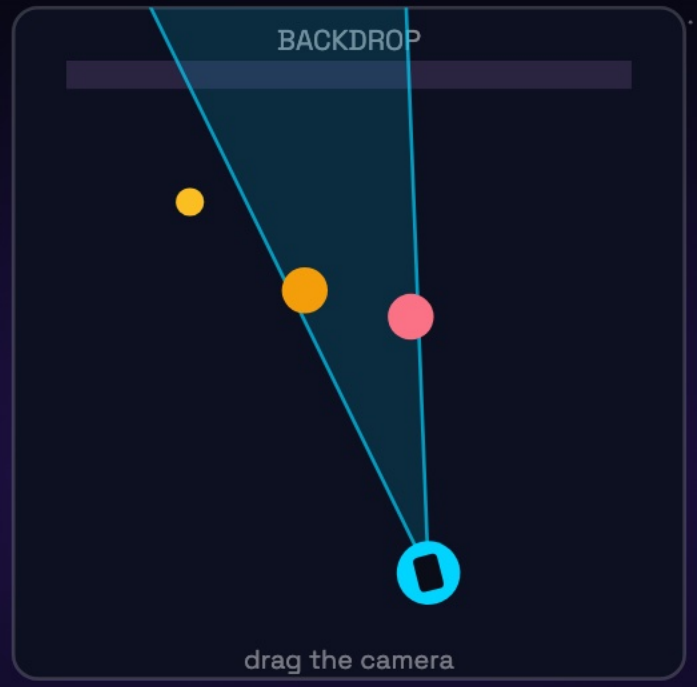



A normal film. Any screen.

# Find the Shot Before You Fly

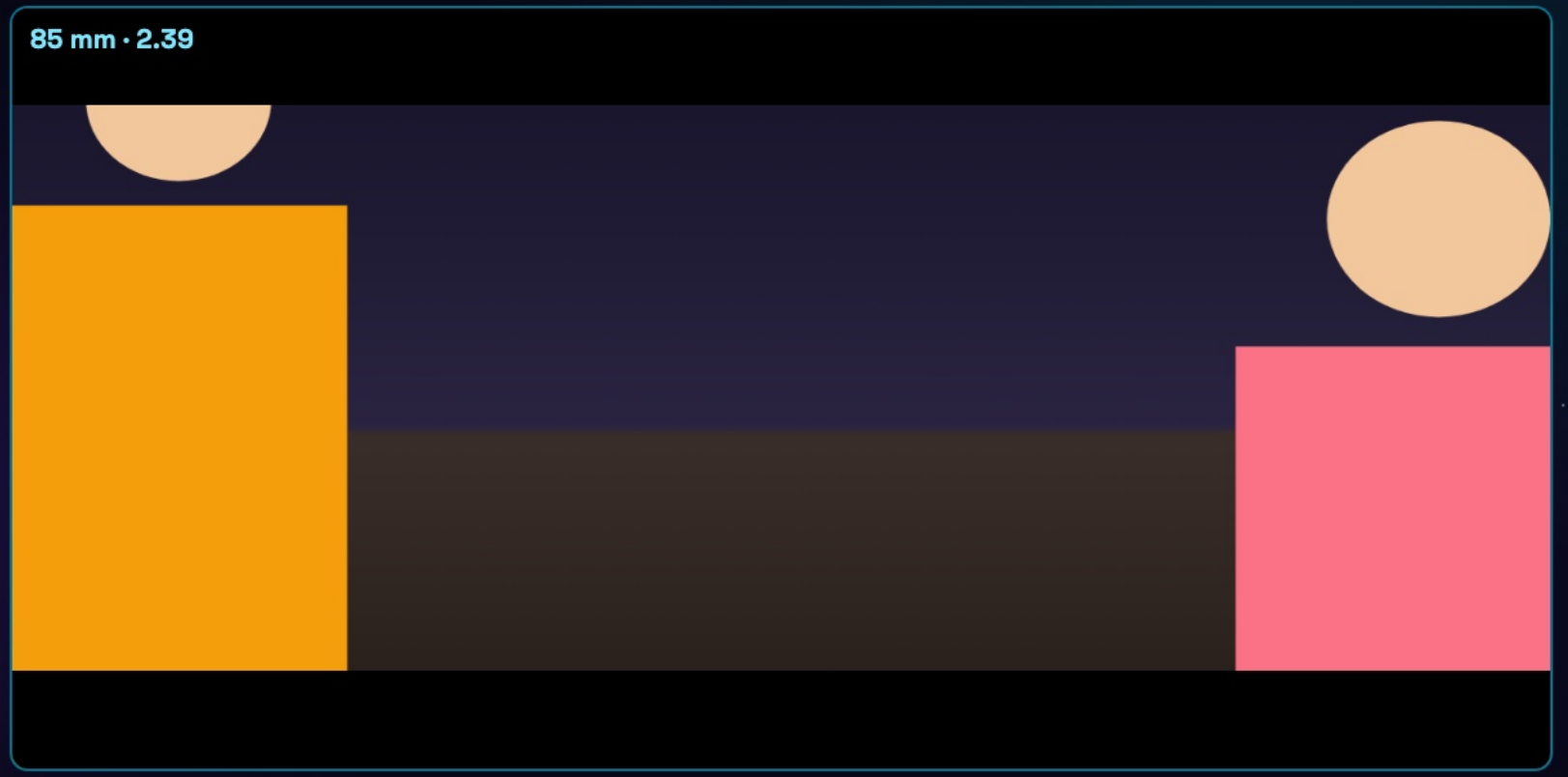
Drag the camera. Pick a lens. Take the shot.

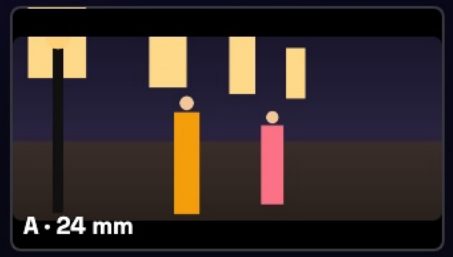
CONCEPT DEMO, BUILT FOR THIS TALK

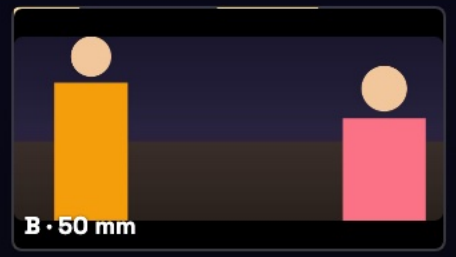



24 mm | 35 mm | 50 mm | 85 mm

2.39 mask | Take shot






# Cut Your Own Version of the Show

At our table today: a prototype built overnight for MIA



THE RECORDING

## The full show, recorded

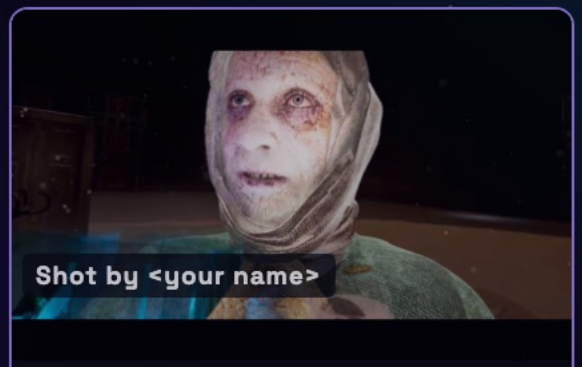
Laptop and gamepad, offline. Default scene: Dickens and Scrooge




YOU

## You are the camera operator

Fly a virtual camera through the performance; 24, 35, 50 or 85 mm




YOUR SHOT

## Your shot, credited

Add or replace a shot anywhere in the show




A NEW CUT

## A new cut of the whole show

Plays back in 2.39 with a WORKING CUT title card; survives a crash; exports

Recorded show — Your camera — Credited — Working cut

ACT IV · 4 / 4

# What Kind of Partnerships Are We Looking For?

Two kinds. Both start with a story you already own or produce.

1 · IP-extension partnerships

*With producers and rights holders*

# Bring the story. We'll build the way in.

*An immersive edition of a world audiences already love: live, location-based, or at home*



2 · Co-productions from day one

*Immersive inside the financing and distribution plan*

# In the plan, not bolted on after.

*Budgeted with the production: new windows, new audiences, assets that carry across formats*

RSC rehearsal R&D · Agile Lens

How we start

# One story.
# One audience.
# One prototype.

*A short, paid prototype of a single audience moment, then a production plan you can finance*


Craft makes them care.
Engineering makes sure they can.

GRAZIE

# Let’s Build the Way In.

IP-extension partnerships · Co-productions with immersive in the plan from day one

WEB agilelens.com

FIND US Demo area, Sala Trianon

Agile Lens

Say hello

Agile Lens